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TED Talk @ the red dot: The Curious Case of Bharat by Vikas Surani @ NBS

This Story Was Waiting for a Red Dot

**Vikas Surani**

Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA



December 22, 2025

Hello Curious Minds,

Some stories take years to tell. Some moments take minutes on a red dot. And some journeys... only make sense when you pause and look back.

Last month, one such moment unfolded for me.

My TED Talk — *The Curious Case of Bharat* — is now live. can't wait, watch now, read later!



I won't spoil it for you. Because this story isn't meant to be *read*. It's meant to be *felt*.

But I do want to share **why this talk matters to me**, and **who stood quietly behind it** — many of whom couldn't be named on stage, but deserve to be acknowledged here.

This wasn't a solo journey

If this talk has a spine, it was built much earlier than the red dot. [Shahbaz Pirvani Chirag Dhorda](#) *small town boys where it all begun!*

It began with **failure** — and the people who didn't let that failure define me.

- A **father**, who, when his son failed 12th grade, didn't raise his voice — but raised his belief.
- and A **brother** [Rohit Surani](#), who reminded me during uncertain times that life is never just *win or lose* — it's *learn and move forward*. (Some people show up once. Some show up every time. That matters.)

It grew through places that shaped curiosity

Long before titles and roles, there were classrooms, benches (often the last ones), and conversations.

- [ATMIYA UNIVERSITY](#), where engineering didn't just teach me computers — it allowed curiosity to wander.
- [Ahmedabad University Vineeta Anandan \(PhD\) Pankaj Chandra](#), where an MBA didn't give answers — but helped me ask better questions.
- it continues now at [Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad](#)

Education, I've learned, isn't about pedigree. It's about permission — permission to explore.

It took form through friendships and first bets

Some ideas are ahead of their time. Some friendships are ahead of careers.

- Two college friends — [Bhavin Shah](#) and [Mukund Ubhadiya \(PMP®\)](#) — with whom curiosity turned into *Device Control Over Internet* long before IoT became a buzzword.

And then came the **first real professional belief**.

- [Evosys](#) — leaders like [Umang Nahata](#), [Ummed Singh Nahata](#), and [Rakesh Raman](#) — who took a chance on local talent, curiosity, and potential before it was fashionable to do so. [Snehal Chaniyara Hirendrasingh Chauhan Diwakar Rao](#)

Opportunities change trajectories. Belief accelerates them.

It deepened when purpose met impact

There was a moment when I walked into a small setup and saw young women doing dignified digital work — in the same place where their mothers once worked very differently.

That moment came through [Self Employed Women's Association \(SEWA\)](#), and through leaders like Elaben Bhat, Reema Ben, who reminded me of something powerful:

■ *Bharat doesn't need charity. Bharat needs a chance.*

That line stayed with me. You'll hear why — when you watch the talk.

It sharpened through building for the future

At [Mastek](#), curiosity met scale. [Ashank Desai](#)

Through initiatives like **Project Deep Blue**, and conversations with people like [Ritwik Batabyal](#), I saw how platforms — not just policies — create inclusion.

When you give direction, tools, and trust, talent shows up — regardless of pin code, college, or background.

That's not theory. That's lived experience.

And finally — it came together on the red dot

Preparing for TED is not about memorising lines. It's about shedding everything that isn't *you*.

Conversations with past TED speakers — [Rakesh Godhwani](#), [Dr. Sapan Shah \(PhD\)](#), [Dr. Anurag Mehta](#) — helped reinforce one thing:

■ *Don't perform. Be authentic. Let the story breathe.*

So I did.

a big Thank You

[TED Conferences Narayana Business School](#) for the platform.

Fellow speakers & inspiring ideas [Aditi Raval Sahil Shah Shrenik Shah Umesh Uttamchandani Vishal Tiwari Rushiraj Mori Ushy Mohandas Dishaan Shah Kaushal Gohil](#).

Organizers [Bhanupratap Singh Kaurav Akhila Prasad Yagnesh Gohil Poornapradnya Pandurangi](#)

to my life partner [Rita Surani](#) through all work-life twirls and twists

Why I'm sharing this with you

This talk is not about me. It's about **Bharat** — the one that keeps showing up. The one that learns fast. The one that doesn't wait for permission.

If you've ever:

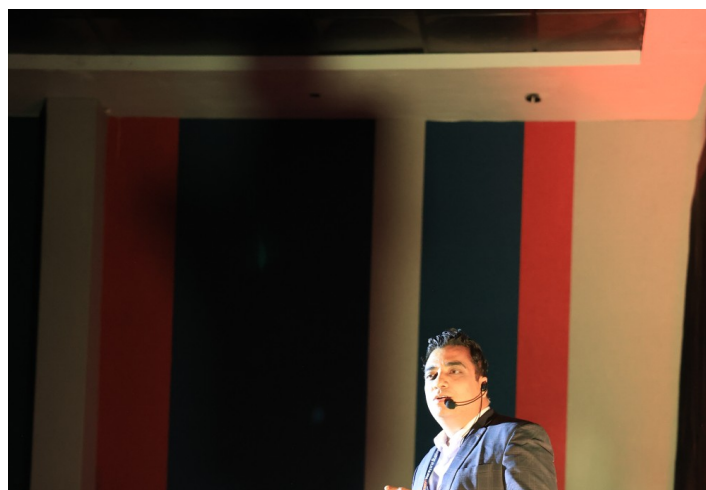
- started from a small town,
- failed early,
- chosen the safer option,
- or wondered if curiosity really counts...

This story might resonate.

👉 **The Curious Case of Bharat — TED Talk is now live.** (I'll let the red dot do the talking.)

When you watch it, just drop one word in the comments — what stayed with you?

Until next time, Stay curious, **Vikas**





The Curious Case of Bharat @ the red dot | Vikas Surani | TEDxNBS

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Vikas reflected on how growing up in smaller towns shapes a unique way of thinking. He spoke about...

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Vikas Surani brilliant

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Many congratulations **Vikas Surani**. Our CR rocks 🙌

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Thank you, Vikas — truly appreciate your kind words 😊

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- **Shivangini Pandey (Shivi)**  • 1st
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- It was indeed a privilege to experience your Red Dot story at TEDx. You are a true inspiration and a remarkable speaker. Congratulations sir. 🌸
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- **Vikas Surani**  Author
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA
- Vishnu Vandana** Thank you, Vishnu — appreciate your wishes. Glad the story resonated. Would love to hear what stayed with you.
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- **Vishruta Mattu (she/her)**  • 1st
Vice President- Human Resources. ET HR Emerging Leader 2023, N...
- What stayed with me was the sheer grit. On to many more milestones!
- Support · 🗨️ 1 | Reply · 1 reply
- **Vikas Surani**  Author
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA
- Vishruta Mattu (she/her)** Thank you, Vishruta — grit is a powerful takeaway.

From our very first immersion and being laughing partners on the same bench, it's been a great start to the learning journey. On to

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Nitin Anand · 1st
Senior Leader | Strategic Growth & Value Creation | Business Consoli...

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Vikas Surani Congratulations and all the best!

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Vikas Surani Author
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

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Nitin Anand Thank you, Nitin ji. Appreciate your wishes — good to be on this learning journey together at [Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad](#)

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aprajita aditya · 1st
Senior Software Engineer

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Congratulations **Vikas Surani** and alii the best

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Vikas Surani Author
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

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aprajita aditya Thank you, Aprajita — really appreciate your wishes. Glad the story resonated, and wishing you the very best on your own journey as well.

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Vikas Surani Author
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

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Bharathi Raghunathan Thank you, Bharathi — really appreciate your wishes. It's good learning alongside someone so open-hearted at [Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad](#).

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Being Curious

A weekly newsletter where I share quick insights, experiences, and lessons learned from my journey.



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